

Table 1: Pros and cons of open source software

	Pros	Cons
1	Development and implementation cost is low	Support and maintenance cost may be hidden in the initial package
2	More easy data transferability	Being open to all, code may be more vulnerable to the hacker community
3	Potential for fast cycle time of releases and bug fixes	Open source solutions may require additional development to enable integration with an existing proprietary environment
4	No limit on usage or target audience	Introduction of new programs/ software may require staff retraining to enable them to use open source solutions
5	Suitable for rapid prototyping and experimentation	Those considering using and developing open source 'in-house' must ensure that they have the right level of expertise to manage it effectively
6	Opportunities for customisation and innovation	Open source solutions may require additional development to enable integration with an existing proprietary environment

CSS stands for Cascading Style Sheets. CSS is responsible for what the Web page will look like. It takes care of all styling and formatting. It is a separate file, which is embedded into the main HTML source code and works alongside it. With HTML, you can create your own blog or website within minutes and with minimal programming effort.

Creating Web applications with PHP

If you wish to create more responsive and good looking Web applications, then PHP is the name of the game for you. PHP has been in the picture for the last 20 years and is considered the best Web development framework even now. JavaScript doesn't have any compatibility issues with any browser, which means you can run it on any browser. Besides, it can be used for both front-end and back-end systems, serving as a complete backbone for your system. There is much debate over the comparative superiority of PHP and Java, but PHP is easier to learn and code than Java. Other names in the list include Python, Ruby, Action Script and JavaScript, all of which are also quite powerful but PHP scores over them.

Use Ruby and Python when fast prototyping is required

Designers who want some back-end programming to test their applications can rely on Ruby and Python. Both are dynamic and object-oriented programming languages with very easy

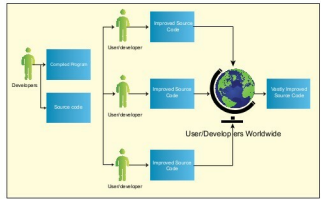


Figure 1: Open Source development process

learning environments. The main reason for these two being so popular is their strong developer community. A very large user base and their collaborative efforts have made them very popular. On the Internet, you can find so many engaging Web portals and forums to guide you to learn programming from the basics to advanced levels.

Python is preferred when you have to learn machine programming or artificial intelligence. For all robotics and human interaction technology, use Python.

Build Android applications with Java

With the rise of Android, the term 'open source' has become more universally accepted. Right now, Java is the only easy-to-learn and effective programming language for building Android applications. Whether you have a Windows or Mac machine, you can get your working app ready within minutes and it can be tested on your local mobile device. To learn Java, you do not have to be aware of programming terms. Even a beginner can, with practice, become a hard core programming enthusiast.

Build iOS applications with Objective-C

On your Mac machine you can build iOS applications compatible to run on the iPhone, iPad or iPod devices. It uses Objective-C as the programming language and this is so robust, it enables you to build full fledged applications. As compared to the Android platform, iOS devices have very

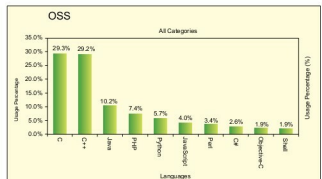


Figure 2: Popularity graph of programming languages